

[Module 0] Review the Syllabus

3/17/2026

Review the Syllabus

What is this course about?

Do you find yourself wondering why people behave the way they do? If so, you will probably very much enjoy this course! We will explore what makes people want to help other people, why sleep is critical in helping you learn, why it is so easy for your memories to go astray, and how psychology can relate directly to your major and future career. The best part about this course (at least for me) is that it is both interesting and fun!

Class time will be technology free! We will keep phones and other devices put away during class time.

(See [Flannigan et al., 2024](https://link.springer.com/article/10.1007/s10648-024-09914-w)  <https://link.springer.com/article/10.1007/s10648-024-09914-w>) for research on why)

Meet Your Professor

Hello! I'm Professor Hill, and I'm excited to learn alongside you this term. I direct the Morgan Teaching and Learning Center and teach in the Social Science and Policy Studies department. My own educational journey took me from a Master's at the University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign to a Ph.D. at Florida State University, during which I explored how we pay attention and process information using eye movements (e.g., reading).

For more than 20 years, I've taught introductory psychology, and it remains my favorite course because I think it does a great job of connecting immediately to your life and future career. I integrate my research on attention and effective methods of teaching and learning into my courses, so you'll notice that I do my best to design activities to help you think critically, apply concepts to real situations, and retain what you learn beyond the final exam.

I know that the first year can feel overwhelming, so my goal is to make this class a space where you feel supported, challenged, and curious. Please reach out during student drop-in hours or by email whenever you have questions. I'm here to help you succeed and to make this learning experience meaningful and fun for both of us.



If you want to get to know me more personally, you can watch this [2:32 video](https://youtu.be/d06oPkvhqfw?si=ht-Vq80RawqTc7F_-)  https://youtu.be/d06oPkvhqfw?si=ht-Vq80RawqTc7F_-.

Professor Hill's Contact Information:

 Dr. Hill (she/her/ella)

 Office: 157 West Street, 1st floor #5

 Chat: Microsoft Teams

 Email: jhill3@wpi.edu (<mailto:jhill3@wpi.edu>) (although please message me through the Canvas Inbox so your message doesn't get lost!)

📞 Text/Call: 508-831-6550

🕒 Student Drop-In Hours: Fridays at 10am (right after class)

Make a private appointment here: [My Bookings](#) ➡

(<https://outlook.office.com/bookwithme/user/d608a9194c0b4cb4b618f8eb1fef3468@wpi.edu/meetingtype/TP3thQ4JPke2y5ffs806cg2?bookingcode=5f1f1635-9e74-42ed-a293-5b9b2e3dc2ea&anonymous&ismsaljsauthenabed&ep=mlink>).(if there's not something free within a couple of days, please email me, and I will make time to see you)

🌱 Safe Learning Environment and Classroom Community

"I am always doing that which I cannot do, in order that I may learn how to do it." —Pablo Picasso

This course is designed for you to push beyond what feels familiar. Here's how we'll make that happen:

What I commit to:

- **I will treat you as a partner in learning.** If life circumstances create barriers to your success (e.g., technology access, time conflicts, health challenges), email me within 48 hours. We'll find a solution together (that's the partner part).
- **I will make space for your perspective.** If course materials seem incomplete or miss important voices, tell me. Send alternate readings or examples, and I'll work them into our class time.
- **I will respond to you as an individual.** You bring different backgrounds, identities, and experiences to this class—all are welcome here! If something I say lands wrong or raises concerns, I want to know so that I can adjust. I want to improve at being inclusive every day.

What I ask of you:

- **Please engage, even when you are uncertain.** Raise your hand, send me a text, or visit student drop-in hours. Your questions help everyone learn!
- **Please extend respect to classmates.** We'll likely encounter ideas and experiences different from our own during our time together. I hope you will approach disagreements with curiosity, not judgment.
- **If something isn't working, please don't wait until the end of the term.** Come talk to me before/after class, during student drop-in hours, or email me to schedule a conversation. My job (and the thing I love most about teaching) is to help you succeed in this course.

📖 Course Description

(This description is from the [Undergraduate Catalog](https://wpi.cleancatalog.net/psy-1400) ➡ (<https://wpi.cleancatalog.net/psy-1400>)). Psychological science is the experimental study of human thought and behavior. Its goal is to contribute to human welfare by developing an understanding of why people do what they do. Experimental psychologists study the entire range of human experience, from infancy until death, from the most abnormal behavior to the most mundane, from the behavior of neurons to the actions of nations. This course offers a broad introduction to important theories, empirical findings, and applications of research in psychological science. Topics will include: use of the scientific method in psychology, evolutionary psychology, behavioral genetics, the anatomy and function of the brain and nervous system, learning, sensation and perception, memory, consciousness, language, intelligence and thinking, life-span development, social cognition and behavior, motivation and emotion, and the nature and treatment of psychological disorders.

🎯 Course Goals

By the end of this course, you will be able to:

1. Understand Core Ideas in Psychology

- You'll explore the big questions psychologists have about how we understand people and the research that connects those ideas to your life and future career.
- *Employers value this because understanding human behavior helps you work well on teams, lead projects, and make better decisions in any STEM field.*

2. Think Like a Scientist

- You'll practice using psychological science to answer questions, evaluate claims, and draw logical conclusions. Psychology is built on the scientific method, and this course will help you see how that method drives discovery and innovation.
- *Employers value this because evidence-based thinking leads to better problem-solving and creative solutions.*

3. Apply Psychology to Real Life

- You'll take what you learn and use it in ways useful to you. That could be improving your study habits, understanding your own (or other's) motivation, or thinking about how psychology shapes technology and society.
- *Employers value this because applying theory to practice is what turns ideas into real-world impact.*

4. Communicate and Collaborate

- You'll strengthen your writing, speaking, and teamwork skills through assignments and group activities.
- *Employers value this because clear communication and collaboration are essential for success in the workplace.*

5. Act Responsibly in a Diverse, Digital World

- You'll learn how ethical principles guide psychology and how to respect diverse perspectives. You'll also practice using AI tools safely, ethically, and effectively as part of your learning. (Don't worry! There are options for folks who choose not to use AI.) This goal also includes prioritizing and emphasizing the human in all of us while we learn and make the world a better place around us. Please see the AI policy for more information.
- *Employers value this because ethical decision-making and technological fluency are desperately needed in today's workforce. Also, transferrable human skills (e.g., teamwork) are deeply valued by employers.*

Course Approach

Later in the Course Orientation Module, you will encounter these helpful items (but I'm putting them here in case it makes more sense to you to look for them here):

- **How This Course Works** (<https://canvas.wpi.edu/courses/86947/pages/module-0-watch-the-how-this-course-works-video>)
- **How to Succeed in This Course** (<https://canvas.wpi.edu/courses/86947/pages/module-0-watch-the-how-to-succeed-in-this-course-video>).

Relevant Skills

Below are important skills that will position you for success in this course:

- How to navigate Canvas, including setting up your personal Canvas Notifications, check your gradebook, turn in assignments, etc.
- How to record audio/video files and take photos
- How to work effectively in a team (although we will also practice this)
- How to study effectively and avoid myths of learning

Materials, Fees, and Technical Requirements

You will need to purchase access to the [LumenOne psychology textbook and engagement platform](https://nam11.safelinks.protection.outlook.com/?)  (<https://nam11.safelinks.protection.outlook.com/?>)

[url=https%3A%2F%2Fwpi.bncollege.com%2Fwebapp%2Fwcs%2Fstores%2Fservlet%2FTBLListView%3FcatalogId%3D10001%26storeId%3D32554%26langId%3D-1%26courseXml%3D%253Ctextbookorder%2520xml%3D%2522%2522%253E%253Ccourses%253E%253Ccourse%2520dept%3D%2522%2522%2520num%3D%25221400%2522%2520sect%3D%2522D01%2522%2520term%3D%2522S26%2522%253E%253C%2Fcourse%253E%253C%2Fcourses%253E%253C%2Ftextbookorder%253E&data=05%7C02%7Cjhill3%40wpi.edu%7C1829cb7c97384c1d230008de6d6ebd32%7C589c76f5ca1541f9884b55ec15a0672a%7C0%7C0%7C639068519538568931%7CUnknown%7CTWFPbGZsb3d8eyJFbXB0eU1hcGkiOnRydWUslYiOilwLjAuMDAwMCIsIiAiOiJXaW4zMilskFOljoITWFPbClldUljoyfQ%3D%3D%7C0%7C%7C%7C&sdata=rMbnja12CNdaQmSryHrmMHwjDxqWBFEnJS2Etj%2F4KNo%3D&reserved=0](https%3A%2F%2Fwpi.bncollege.com%2Fwebapp%2Fwcs%2Fstores%2Fservlet%2FTBLListView%3FcatalogId%3D10001%26storeId%3D32554%26langId%3D-1%26courseXml%3D%253Ctextbookorder%2520xml%3D%2522%2522%253E%253Ccourses%253E%253Ccourse%2520dept%3D%2522%2522%2520num%3D%25221400%2522%2520sect%3D%2522D01%2522%2520term%3D%2522S26%2522%253E%253C%2Fcourse%253E%253C%2Fcourses%253E%253C%2Ftextbookorder%253E&data=05%7C02%7Cjhill3%40wpi.edu%7C1829cb7c97384c1d230008de6d6ebd32%7C589c76f5ca1541f9884b55ec15a0672a%7C0%7C0%7C639068519538568931%7CUnknown%7CTWFPbGZsb3d8eyJFbXB0eU1hcGkiOnRydWUslYiOilwLjAuMDAwMCIsIiAiOiJXaW4zMilskFOljoITWFPbClldUljoyfQ%3D%3D%7C0%7C%7C%7C&sdata=rMbnja12CNdaQmSryHrmMHwjDxqWBFEnJS2Etj%2F4KNo%3D&reserved=0)).

(\$48.54) for this course, which provides digital course materials designed using open educational resources (OER) instead of a traditional textbook. You can access all the readings, videos, quizzes, and other activities through our course site on Canvas, which is accessible on your computer, tablet, or phone. LumenOne has added new material, videos, self-checks, and more to the original OER text. You can find these in the Canvas Modules labeled as the STUDY PLAN.

Alongside LumenOne, we will also use the following technology during the semester. I will give you more information and support both in class and on Canvas regarding these.

- POGIL Activities (no cost to you)
- Plickers (no cost to you)--these are essentially "paper clickers" so that we can do classroom polling in a low-tech way
- CATME (no cost to you)

Academic Integrity

Academic Integrity Generally

You are expected to be familiar with the ***Student Guide to Academic Integrity at WPI*** that is downloadable from [here](https://www.wpi.edu/about/policies/academic-integrity/student-resources) (<https://www.wpi.edu/about/policies/academic-integrity/student-resources>). Consequences for violating the **Academic Honest Policy** (<https://www.wpi.edu/about/policies/academic-integrity/dishonesty>) range from earning a zero on the assignment, failing the course, or being suspended or expelled from WPI.

Common examples of violations include:

- Copying and pasting text directly from a source without providing appropriately cited credit
- Paraphrasing, summarizing, or rephrasing from a source without providing appropriate citations
- Collaborating on individual assignments
- Turning in work where some portion of the work is someone else's, even if properly cited

Artificial Intelligence and Academic Integrity

Why I've made these choices about AI

As Director of the Morgan Teaching and Learning Center, I am constantly examining AI use in higher education, including the impact it can have on you as a learner. I often use AI to try and push the limits of what it can do in a teaching and learning setting. I expose myself to the ethical, sustainability, labor, and societal implications of AI in order to refine my own philosophy of its use.

A few ideas and findings that have impacted my current thoughts around AI include:

- Generative AI is just a statistical text predictor (e.g., [You are Not A Parrot, and A Chatbot is Not Human](https://nymag.com/intelligencer/article/ai-artificial-intelligence-chatbots-emily-m-bender.html)  (<https://nymag.com/intelligencer/article/ai-artificial-intelligence-chatbots-emily-m-bender.html>)). It will always create average text that is high probability. Nothing it produces will ever be new or innovative.
- It is trained to sound confident as it provides answers. If it doesn't know, it guesses what might be plausible, even when that guess is factually wrong. That can lead non-experts and learners astray in ways that can be harmful (e.g., [Why Language Models Hallucinate](https://arxiv.org/abs/2509.04664)  (<https://arxiv.org/abs/2509.04664>)). Toor (2026) describes the problem with ChatGPT's hallucinations clearly:

OpenAI's proposed fix [to hallucinations]? Have ChatGPT say "I don't know" when it's unsure. Their own math shows this would mean roughly 30% of your questions get no answer. Imagine asking ChatGPT something three times out of ten and getting "I'm not confident enough to respond." Users would leave overnight. So the fix exists, but it would kill the product.

- Radiologists sometimes perform more poorly after using AI (e.g., [Budzyn et al., 2025](https://www.thelancet.com/journals/langas/article/PIIS2468-1253(25)00133-5/abstract) [↗](https://www.thelancet.com/journals/langas/article/PIIS2468-1253(25)00133-5/abstract)) or it improves/worsens performance in unpredictable ways ([Yu et al., 2024](https://www.nature.com/articles/s41591-024-02850-w) [↗](https://www.nature.com/articles/s41591-024-02850-w)). Because we don't know what the long-term implications are for learning or professional performance right now, caution is warranted. If trained professionals perform less reliably when they over-rely on AI, what might that mean for people who are still learning? (e.g., [The effects of over-reliance on AI dialogue systems on students' cognitive abilities](https://link.springer.com/article/10.1186/s40561-024-00316-7) [↗](https://link.springer.com/article/10.1186/s40561-024-00316-7).)
- There are problematic trends in human-AI relationships. As we are studying human behavior in this class, so I think it's important to consider this. Humans tend to anthropomorphize and end up treating non-human animals and objects as having human abilities and traits (e.g., [the Eliza effect](https://99percentinvisible.org/episode/the-eliza-effect/) [↗](https://99percentinvisible.org/episode/the-eliza-effect/)). This has led to unhealthy and even harmful human-AI relationships (e.g., [Illusions of Intimacy: Emotional Attachment and Emerging Psychological Risks in Human-AI Relationships](https://scale.stanford.edu/ai/repository/illusions-intimacy-emotional-attachment-and-emerging-psychological-risks-human-ai/) [↗](https://scale.stanford.edu/ai/repository/illusions-intimacy-emotional-attachment-and-emerging-psychological-risks-human-ai/)).

As a certain fictional chaos theorist put it: "[You] ... were so preoccupied with whether or not [you] could that [you] didn't stop to think if [you] should." In other words, I want folks to pause, be thoughtful, and consider the ethical implications of what they are doing with AI before they use it (e.g., [Stephen Hawking's warning](https://www.bbc.com/news/technology-30290540) [↗](https://www.bbc.com/news/technology-30290540)). Although I share these concerns (among others) and observations, I firmly believe that AI has the potential to do very interesting and even helpful things. If you have read this far in the AI policy, send me an email with a picture of a cute baby animal, and I will give you an extra token. It also tells me you actually read the policy, which I appreciate more than you know.

I would love to talk with you about any of the choices I have made about AI. Come to student drop-in hours!

Expectations around AI

Here is how my philosophy (above) translates into specific expectations for this course. If AI does all the work and a student cuts and pastes it into a submission, that is a violation of academic integrity. Sometimes there are more subtle things that also count as academic integrity violations. For example, consider an example from Dr. Cardamone from Tufts University. She described two hypothetical situations related to AI use and academic integrity during a workshop I recently attended. As you read these, ask yourself: in each case, who did the work of learning?

- A student who has a native language other than English works hard on an assignment, does all the thinking, drafts, revises, and polishes their paper. Because they are insecure about their writing in their non-native language, they put their writing into AI and ask it to make it sound even more polished. The student does not declare that they used AI on their assignment as their professor requested because they are embarrassed of their language skills.
- A student offloads their thinking to AI, asking it to create options for an assignment, directing it to build parts of the assignment directly, then types what AI creates into a separate document, adjusting it to fit how they would say it. The student does not declare their use of AI as their professor requested because they've made their work sound human made and don't want their professor to know they used AI.

Both of the situations above count as a violation of academic integrity, although they vary based on severity. The first student would have been fine had they simply declared their use of AI. Even if the second student declared their use of AI, it would have been a violation of academic integrity. **The underlying question to evaluate these situations is: Who has done the work of learning and the work of demonstrating that learning?**

In this course, there are times you can use AI and times you cannot. You may **never** use AI to complete whole parts of assignments, that includes the planning portions, thinking portions, writing portions, etc. If you do use AI, you must declare you have used it and provide detailed information about how you have used it. For example, in a recent manuscript I submitted, I included the following disclosure:

During the final stages of manuscript preparation, we utilized Microsoft Copilot to identify places that could be improved in the manuscript because our institutions have contractual business agreements with Microsoft that protect our intellectual property. We created a persona for the "Agent" feature of Copilot that would only describe issues and never provide revised text. We would use our own human judgement on which issues to address and our own writing to make modifications to the manuscript. See Supplementary File 3 for information on the persona and prompts we used.

I then created a six page document that included the prompts I used, a sample interaction, and sample responses. All of the work I did with AI can now be viewed and reproduced. This approach is in alignment with the standards of the journal and the ethical guidelines of my field.

What you may and may not do with AI

In this course, AI may be used to support your learning, but it may not be used to replace the thinking, **productive struggle**  (<https://pce.sandiego.edu/productive-struggle-in-the-classroom/>), and intellectual work that are yours to do.

What you <u>may</u> do with AI	What you may <u>not</u> do with AI
Use AI to help you <i>prepare</i> for assessments. Example: asking it to generate practice questions, quiz you on course concepts, or help you identify gaps in your understanding.	Use AI to <i>complete</i> assessments for you. Example: copying a quiz question, assignment instructions, etc. into AI and submitting what it produces.
Use AI to generate ideas, then evaluate them and make them your own. Example: asking for possible paper topics, then choosing, revising, and reshaping them so the final submission reflects your own thinking.	Use AI-generated ideas without evaluating and revising them. Example: taking AI's suggested outline, argument, etc. and building your work directly on it as though it were your own.
Use AI to think through and get feedback on your writing without letting it write for you. Example: describing your argument and asking for gaps in your logic or asking where your draft is unclear, then you revise on your own.	Use AI to do graded work for you. Example: having it write part or all of a paper, discussion post, reflection, write-up, script, or other assignment you submit for credit. (This includes LLMs and agentic AI).
Use AI to challenge your thinking. Example: asking it to play Devil's Advocate, question your reasoning, or point out gaps in your argument.	Accept AI's reasoning as your own conclusion. Example: asking AI what it thinks about a topic, agreeing with its answer, and presenting that position as your own without doing any thinking on your own.
Use AI to clarify difficult concepts. Example: asking it to explain a complex idea in simpler language or for a specific audience (e.g., soccer fans, Pokémon enthusiasts) so you can better understand it yourself.	Use AI to completely bypass confusion. Example: reaching for a quick AI explanation before wrestling with the reading, your class notes, or course materials.
Use AI to help you locate things or find additional resources. Example: using NotebookLM to find where a concept appears in your notes or readings, using Canvas' AI tool to locate things, or asking AI to resources (as long as you then verify them).	Use AI as a substitute for reading or research. Example: asking it to summarize your assigned readings, or relying on AI-generated source lists without finding, reading, or verifying the sources yourself.
Use AI tools embedded in apps you already use appropriately. Example: Grammarly for grammar checking, Word's Editor for spell-check, or Google's suggestions for sentence-level errors (but only within the limits described in this policy).	Let embedded AI tools do the writing work for you. Example: highlighting a paragraph in Word and then using Copilot to "rewrite" or "improve."
Use AI for transcription or note-taking support. Example: using a transcription tool to capture spoken content from a lecture or video so you can return to it, annotate it, and study from it alongside your own notes. (Please do not share these with others or post them on the internet without my written permission. I give permission only for your personal use.)	Use AI as a substitute for engaging with the course. Example: having AI summarize a lecture recording instead of attending.

What you <u>may</u> do with AI	What you may <u>not</u> do with AI
Be transparent about permissible AI use and take ownership of your revisions. Example: adding a brief note at the end of an assignment explaining what you asked AI to do and how you modified or built on what it produced.	Use AI to disguise or misrepresent authorship. Example: running a draft through AI to reword it so it sounds original or passes detection software, or submitting work shaped by AI-generated reasoning or language without disclosing it.
Use AI to plan and organize your work. Example: asking it to help you build a weekly study schedule so you can make time for reading, drafting, exam preparation, etc.	
Use AI for language support (e.g., translation). Example: asking it to clarify dense academic text, psychological jargon, translate a word or passage from the book if English is not your native language, etc.	
Use AI as a questioner or study partner. Example: asking it to quiz you, ask follow-up questions, or help you figure out what you actually know (i.e., fostering good metacognition!).	

If you are thinking of using in AI in other ways, that could be great! Please run your idea by me so that I can make sure you're falling into the safe zone of this policy.

Our Responsibilities

Student Responsibilities:

- Attend class! Research shows a direct correlation between classroom attendance and grade performance. Therefore, my expectation is that you will attend all class days that you are healthy enough to do so. Attendance means being in class, arriving on time, and actively participating in class discussions, demonstrations, POGIL activities, and other exercises.
- If you are ill, you will take time away from class so that you can rest and recover as well as helping prevent the spread of illness. (I'm on an immunosuppressant, so I need your help!). I've included flexibility in the coursework, so missing a few days won't hurt your grade.
- Be accountable by setting aside regular times each week to complete course activities and assignments on time, as noted by the due dates.
- If you don't know how already, learn how to use Canvas, including communication tools such as Announcements, Canvas Inbox, and If you have technology-related problems, use the **WPI Help Portal** (
- Abide by ethical standards and adhere to WPI's standards of academic integrity. Your work must be your own, and you cannot use or recycle material, assignments, etc. from other courses for this course.
- Contact me as early as possible if an emergency arises. It's easier for me to help the earlier I know about your situation.

Professor Responsibilities:

- Respond to emails within one working day (please keep in mind that Saturday and Sunday are **NOT** working days). If I receive multiple questions/emails regarding the same question or concern, I may respond to them with an announcement to the entire class rather than responding to folks individually.
- Provide timely, meaningful, and constructive feedback on assignments. (See the Feedback Pyramid in the **How This Course Works** (<https://canvas.wpi.edu/courses/86947/pages/module-0-watch-the-how-this-course-works-video>) page)
- Facilitate an effective learning experience.
- Refer students to appropriate services for issues that are non-course content specific, such as technical issues, writing labs, accessibility services, etc.
- Mentor students through the course.

Grading

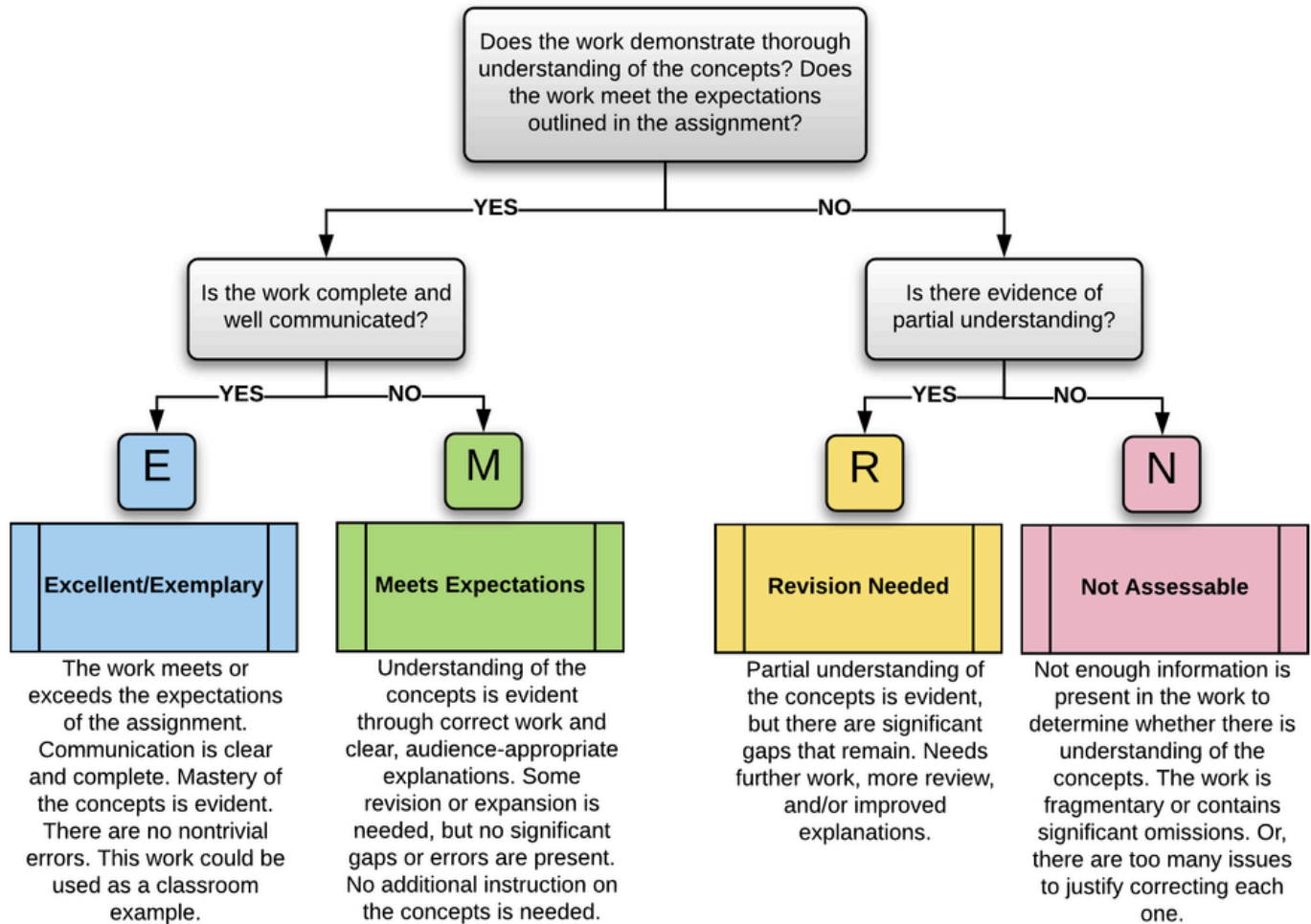
I will be using **specifications grading** [↗\(https://www.taylorfrancis.com/books/mono/10.4324/9781003447061/specifications-grading-linda-nilson-claudia-stanny\)](https://www.taylorfrancis.com/books/mono/10.4324/9781003447061/specifications-grading-linda-nilson-claudia-stanny) in this course, which is a research-based approach to assessing learning that focuses on mastery rather than trying to get as many points as possible. Everyone in this course can earn an A grade (and I would be very happy if you did!).

How does specifications grading work?

Most professional qualifications work exactly like this system. Lawyers pass the bar exam. Doctors pass medical licensing boards. Teachers pass certification exams. To be **licensed by the State of Massachusetts** [↗\(https://www.mass.gov/how-to/how-to-apply-for-an-accountancy-license\)](https://www.mass.gov/how-to/how-to-apply-for-an-accountancy-license) as a Certified Public Accountant, individuals must the Uniform CPA Examination. Essentially, that's specifications grading. In every case, there's a defined standard — you either meet it or you don't. Partial credit doesn't get you a law license. That's the logic behind specifications grading, and it's the logic behind this course.

Here's what that means for you: before you begin any assignment, you will know exactly what I'm looking for. No guessing or reading between the lines. When I evaluate your work, I'm checking each item on the specifications checklist. Each item will be met or not met. But don't worry if an assignment doesn't meet specifications. That's why there are tokens (see below). You can spend one to resubmit the work to meet specifications.

The one exception to the meet/does not meet binary is reflective writing, which doesn't lend itself to a simple yes/no. Reflections are evaluated using the EMRN rubric described below (or something very similar). E and M count as Meets Specifications while R and N do not. As you plan your grade bundle, pay attention to whether any assignments require a specific number of E ratings — that detail will be noted clearly in the bundle description.



EMRN rubric based on the EMRF rubric, due to Rodney Stutzman and Kimberly Race: <http://eric.ed.gov/?id=EJ717675>
 EMRN rubric by Robert Talbert is licensed under CC BY-SA 4.0



Grade Bundles

Please review the grade bundles below. Each grade bundle lists the amount of coursework needed to successfully earn the grade. After you review them, pick the grade you want to earn. You will be asked to indicate your desired grade within the Course Orientation Module. The number in the table below is the number of assignments or activities that need to be completed in that category. There are more items available in most categories than required (e.g., there are 11 Study Plans but only 9 are required for

an A grade). Some categories require all people to complete them (i.e., course orientation, group functioning, research experience).

Grade Bundles Overview	A	B	C
Course Orientation Assignments	✓ 3	✓ 3	✓ 3
Class Participation	✓ 7	✓ 6	✓ 5
Study Plan Engagement and Quizzes	✓ 9	✓ 8	✓ 6
Group Micro-Projects	✓ 2	✓ 2	✓ 1
Exams	✓ 4	✓ 3	✓ 2
POGIL Activities and Quizzes	✓ 7	✓ 6	✓ 5
Group Functioning and Evaluation	✓ 4	✓ 4	✓ 4
Research Experience	✓ 2	✓ 2	✓ 2
Earning Tokens (start with 5)			

Below, I have made checklists for each grade bundle to help you keep track of your progress in the course. Download your grade bundle checklist so that you can use it throughout the course. (It's kind of like a tracking sheet.)

A Grade Bundle Checklist

(<https://canvas.wpi.edu/courses/86947/files/8439888?wrap=1>)



(https://canvas.wpi.edu/courses/86947/files/8439888/download?download_frd=1)

B Grade Bundle Checklist

(<https://canvas.wpi.edu/courses/86947/files/8439887?wrap=1>)



(https://canvas.wpi.edu/courses/86947/files/8439887/download?download_frd=1)

C Grade Bundle Checklist

(<https://canvas.wpi.edu/courses/86947/files/8439886?wrap=1>)



(https://canvas.wpi.edu/courses/86947/files/8439886/download?download_frd=1)

How do tokens work?

At the start of the term, you receive **five (5) tokens**. Tokens are built-in flexibility for the course and a way for you to handle unexpected circumstances without your course performance suffering. You get to decide when and how to spend them based on your own needs.

Because there is already flexibility built into the course (e.g., as I mentioned above, there are 11 Study Plans and each grade bundle asks for less than that), you may only spend tokens on things that need flexibility beyond what is already built into the grade bundle you have chosen. One token buys you either a deadline extension of up to 24 hours or a resubmission on any Study Plans, Module Quizzes, Micro-Projects, and POGIL Activities that do not meet specifications — not both on the same assignment.

How it works:

- To use a token, submit the **Spend a Token Form** (<https://canvas.wpi.edu/courses/86947/assignments/463979>) and indicate what you're using it for.
- For extensions, submit the form **before the original deadline passes**. For resubmissions, submit the form within **three days** of receiving feedback.
- Tokens cannot be used during the final week of the term.
- You do not need to explain to me why you are using a token. They are yours to use as you see fit.
- Once your tokens are gone, they're gone; extensions and resubmissions are no longer available.
- Unused tokens have no effect on your grade.
- If you have formal accommodations through Student Accessibility Services, those apply independently of your token balance — they are not the same thing and are never deducted from it.

A note on strategy: Five tokens sounds like a lot early in the semester. Students who spend freely in weeks two and three sometimes find themselves without options in week six. Alternatively, sometimes students hoard their tokens and never spend them. That doesn't help you in any way! Use them when you need them. I may provide one or two token earning opportunities during the term.

Grade Inquiries

I believe that cultivating personal responsibility and keeping an eye on what's happening in your life is an essential skill to develop. For example, if you don't keep an eye on your bank account, it's really easy to spend too much or be taken advantage of without knowing it! Thus, I want you to practice by keeping an eye on your grades. Please feel free to inquire about your grades or seek further insights into the specifications—I wholeheartedly welcome your curiosity! I hope this will only help both of us because you will understand your course performance and can help me in cases where errors may arise (then I can fix them quickly!).

With that in mind, keep track of your grades throughout the term. Because you have frequent small assignments, I've established a reasonable timeframe for grade inquiries. Once I have grades posted for any assessment, you need to check them within three working days (except as the last day of class approaches—that provides limitations on how long I can give you). After that has passed, the grade will stand. This also simulates real life. How often has a store informed you about a time limit on returns?

The easiest thing to do with your grades is be proactive. First, check your work against the specifications. You can also ask a group member to do that for you, too. Finally, instead of turning the assignment in at the last minute and waiting to see what you get, try sending it to me a few days before the deadline. I can review the assignment with you and give you suggestions on what to improve before you submit it for a grade.

Incomplete Grades

Here is WPI's statement on incomplete grades: Incomplete courses may be granted if the majority of the course is completed; however, no additional credit can be given for missed class discussions or teamwork beyond the end of the course. In addition, in the case of an incomplete, the student is responsible for handing in the final work within the WPI required time frame of one (1) year. After this time, an incomplete grade changes to a no record (NR) grade. For more information, please read about the **WPI Grade System** (<https://www.wpi.edu/offices/registrar/academics/grade-system>).

Assignments and Brief Descriptions

Below are brief descriptions of the assignments for this course. Each one will have more information within the Canvas modules. You may **not** use an AI agent to complete any of these activities or assignments on your behalf.

Course Orientation Assignments

Course Readiness Quiz. During the first week of class, you will have a quiz on information in the Course Orientation Module. You may take the quiz three times. For the first two times, please only use your memory. On the third time, use the information in the Course Orientation Module. Your highest score is the one that will be recorded. To meet specifications, you must score 90% or higher.

Getting to Know You. This is a short activity that will let us get to know each other as humans. Be ready to share things such as your favorite song and meme. Information on how to meet specifications will be in the assignment instructions.

Learning about AI and the AI Policy. I've made a short learning activity that will help you understand the AI policy. I hear from students frequently that they are unclear about whether AI is allowed or not in their classes. I want to make sure you get the clarity you need. To meet specifications, you must score 90% or higher.

Learning Activities

Class Participation: During class, I will ask you about the reading and occasionally ask you other Plicker questions as part of our learning activities. To meet specifications each day, you must answer 75% of the questions in any given class session (correctness does not matter).

Study Plan Engagement. The Study Plan has interactive elements. As you engage with these and complete self-checks, you will earn completion points for doing them. Don't skip these! To meet specifications, you must fully complete each self-check.

Study Plan Quizzes. Each Study Plan has a quiz that you can take twice. To maximize learning, take the first quiz, jot down what you need to study, spend some time studying, then take it again on another day. Taking the quizzes back to back may feel like you are using your time wisely, but it hurts your learning. To meet specifications, your highest quiz score must be 80% or higher. (Because these are essentially practice, I don't mind that your score is lower. HOWEVER, please use your quiz results to help you study and prepare for exams).

Group Micro-Projects. You will complete micro-projects with your group. Each one has an in-class planning component, an applied/experiential component, and a video/audio peer interview component. Information on how to meet specifications will be in the assignment instructions.

Exams. I don't believe that exams are the best assessments, but I do believe they are a wonderful metacognitive process! You will have the opportunity take four exams: Exams 1, 2, and 3, plus the Cumulative Final Exam. For each exam, you will take it individually first, and then you will complete the exam as a group. After each exam, you will reflect on your learning experience. Information on how to meet specifications will be in the assignment instructions. While you can't spend tokens to move an exam, I am happy to work with a group who has a member with a valid reason for missing an exam (e.g., illness, emergency). To meet specifications, you must score 80% or higher after the group exam and complete the post-exam reflection at the E or M levels.

POGIL and Group Activities

POGIL Activities. POGIL stands for Process-Oriented Guided-Inquiry Learning. During POGIL activities, you and your group will work together to build teamwork skills and solve psychology problems while developing your critical thinking skills. Information on how to meet specifications will be in the assignment instructions.

Each of the nine (9) POGIL activities has two parts:

1. **Readiness Quiz** — A short quiz completed before class to confirm you're ready to do the POGIL activity with your group. Completing it makes you eligible to participate in the in-class activity.
2. **POGIL Activity** — There will be eight (8) POGIL activities offered during the term. These must be completed with your team during class, and you must be present to earn credit.

Related Group Assignments. You will also complete a few assignments tied to your group:

- **CATME Survey** — Completed early in the term; I use your responses to form groups. To meet specifications, you must complete this fully by the deadline.
- **Group Constitution** — Your group creates a shared working agreement at the start of the semester. Information on how to meet specifications will be in the assignment instructions.
- **Peer Evaluations (×2):**
 - *First evaluation* — Gives you early feedback on how you're performing as a team member. Information on how to meet specifications will be in the assignment instructions.
 - *Second evaluation and reflection* — Helps you see if you've made progress on your teamwork goals and skill building. Information on how to meet specifications will be in the assignment instructions.

Research Experience

An important goal of this course will be to instill an appreciation of the scientific process. Since the material that you will learn in this course is based on experimental research, I would like you to contribute to the research community by participating firsthand in the process. All students enrolled in this course are expected to participate in two credits. The purpose of this requirement is twofold: 1) to help WPI faculty and students conduct research, and 2) to give you a better understanding of what research participants experience. Certain ethical guidelines govern this research. This will be explained in depth elsewhere in Canvas.

Register with Sona Systems. Create or login to your Sona Systems account and complete the short demographics questionnaire. To meet specifications, you must do both those things by the deadline.

Research Participation Assignment. Complete two credits as a participant or complete the alternative assignment. Information on how to meet specifications will be in the assignment instructions.

Late Work

Each assignment in the course has a deadline. Please complete the assignment by that time. However, because I understand sometimes life happens, I've provided you with tokens for added flexibility (see the token section of the syllabus). Hopefully, this will help you if you become ill, have competing deadlines with other courses, have a personal emergency, or simply lost track of time. If the term is very complicated and you run out of tokens due to illness or emergency, please let me know right away.

Please notify me as soon as possible if there are any potential conflicts with assignments. Extensions on assignments or alternatives will be provided if you must participate in officially sanctioned WPI activities, official athletic activities, religious observances, military responsibilities. Accommodations will also be provided in the case of extenuating circumstances (change in work schedule, death in immediate family/friends, illness, injury).

Policies and Resources

Policies

Artificial Intelligence and Learning. This policy is in the Academic Integrity section.

Academic Accommodations. We at WPI strive to create an inclusive environment where all students are valued members of the class community. If you need course adaptations or accommodations because of a disability, or if you have medical information to share with us that may impact your performance or participation in this course, please make an appointment with us as soon as possible. Students with approved academic accommodation should plan to submit their accommodation letters through the [Office of](#)

Accessibility Services Student Portal  (<https://nam03.safelinks.protection.outlook.com/?url=https%3A%2F%2Fclockwork.wpi.edu%2FClockWork%2Fcustom%2Fmisc%2Fhome.aspx&data=02%7C01%7Ckmarengo%40wpi.edu%7C22931e2c6d094dc8c5b008d82e704f79%7C589c76f5ca1541f9884b55ec15a0672a%7C0%7C0%7C637310407186155797&sdata=cUDQvp%2FujLQggSxO%2BKZISnaJW0E5lIQq2qEJ1C67u3k%3D&reserved=0>).

If you have questions about how accommodation can be provided on this course, contact me as soon as possible. Students who are not currently registered with the Office of Accessibility Services (OAS) but who would like to find out more information regarding requesting accommodations and what that entails should plan to contact them via:

Email: AccessibilityServices@wpi.edu (<mailto:AccessibilityServices@wpi.edu>) and/or

Phone: (508) 831-4908.

On Campus – Unity Hall

Resources

A full list of student resources is available [here](https://www.wpi.edu/student-experience/resources) (<https://www.wpi.edu/student-experience/resources>). I have also highlighted a few important ones below.

Mental Health Resources. At WPI, your mental health and well-being are a priority. If you or someone you know needs support, the following resources are available:

- **WPI Student Development & Counseling Center (SDCC)** (<https://www.wpi.edu/offices/student-development-counseling-center>)
 - Reach out confidentially to SDCC staff to **MAKE AN APPOINTMENT**
Call us at [508-831-5540](tel:508-831-5540) (tel:508-831-5540) or [schedule an appointment online](https://forms.office.com/pages/responsepage.aspx?id=9XacWBXK-UGIS1XsFaBnKoK6q-y0N7BHuoBOIDgIFLpUOFo1WkRQWdu4MEIJQU1LWVI2UTNEUIJXRC4u&utm_source=marketing_cloud_email&utm_medium=January_12_2022&utm_campaign=UMC_3005745&utm_mc_subscriber_id=8468850). 
(https://forms.office.com/pages/responsepage.aspx?id=9XacWBXK-UGIS1XsFaBnKoK6q-y0N7BHuoBOIDgIFLpUOFo1WkRQWdu4MEIJQU1LWVI2UTNEUIJXRC4u&utm_source=marketing_cloud_email&utm_medium=January_12_2022&utm_campaign=UMC_3005745&utm_mc_subscriber_id=8468850)
 - Email: SDCC@wpi.edu (<mailto:SDCC@wpi.edu>)
 - Visit: **16 Einhorn Road**
- If you are aware of a student who may be struggling and in need of outreach, you can connect them with WPI services using the "I'm Concerned About a Student" **Form**  (https://wpi-advocate.symplicity.com/care_report/index.php/pid708222?_gl=1*1wbopi6*_gcl_au*MTU4NTk0NjExMC4xNzM2NDM4MjQ4*_ga*MTk2OTkzNTc3NC4xNzM1NDk0Mjgy*_ga_RE35PKQB7J*MTczNjk0OTEzMS43LjEuMTczNjk2NDg4NC4yOS4wLjA).
- The **National Suicide Prevention Lifeline** is a free, 24/7 service that can provide individuals with support, information, and local resources regarding suicide. Call them at 1-800-273-TALK (8255) or visit suicidepreventionlifeline.org  (<https://suicidepreventionlifeline.org>).

If there is an imminent danger of self-harm or suicidal action:

- **On-Campus:** Call WPI Campus Police at **508-831-5555**
- **Off-Campus:** Dial **911**

Library Access. As a student at WPI (Worcester Polytechnic Institute), you have access to various resources through the library. Use the link [here](https://www.wpi.edu/library) (<https://www.wpi.edu/library>) to access databases, e-journals, and/or e-books. You must log in with your WPI username and password to access materials.

Writing Center. Would you like feedback on a paper that you're writing--or even a presentation or academic poster that you're creating? The Writing Center is here for you! Located in Salisbury Labs 233, the Writing Center offers free one-on-one consultations (in-person and over Zoom) to help you improve your communication skills. Tutors will read/listen to your work, give you feedback about your composition's strengths and weaknesses, and help you (and your team) chart a path forward as you revise. And since tutors are WPI students themselves, you can count on a friendly and supportive atmosphere. Consultations are open to all WPI students, undergraduate and graduate, for all classes and projects (even projects you're doing outside of class), and tutors will happily work with you at any stage of your process—early brainstorming, revising a draft, polishing a final draft. To see appointment

options for both in-person and Zoom meetings, go to wpi.mywconline.com, or learn more about our services by visiting our homepage: wpi.edu/+writing

Technology Support

Visit the Help Portal and login to fully access WPI's knowledge base for self-help, report an issue you encountered, request assistance and view information about IT services, locations and hours.

The Help Portal (<https://help.wpi.edu/>).

ID Services Information (<https://www.wpi.edu/offices/id-services>).

ITS News (<https://help.wpi.edu/news?search=>).

Other Course Information

Names and Pronouns: In this course, we will respect and refer to people using the names and personal pronouns that they share. Visit [pronoun resources \(https://www.wpi.edu/offices/diversity/student-resources/lgbtqiap-student-support/pronoun-resources\)](https://www.wpi.edu/offices/diversity/student-resources/lgbtqiap-student-support/pronoun-resources) to learn more.

Extra Help: If you discover you are having trouble, contact me as soon as possible. I am invested in your success and am willing to meet as frequently as necessary after class or during student drop-in hours. I am also available for appointments outside of student drop-in hours.

Extra Information: If you are interested in exploring the course material in greater depth, please let me know! I would be so excited to help you find more resources that match your interests.

Religious Observances: Please check your calendars against the course schedule. If you have a conflict in the exam schedule or feel that you will be disadvantaged in completing assignments or assessments due to religious observance, please reach out to me as soon as possible! I will make alternate arrangements with you to accommodate any religious observances.

Copyright Statement: The materials in this course are copyrighted (by me, the publisher, or others). They are intended for use only by students registered and enrolled in this course and only for instructional activities associated with and for the duration of the course. **They may not be retained in another medium or disseminated further (because that could put you at risk for a copyright violation!).** They are provided in compliance with the provisions of the **TEACH Act**  (<https://www.copyright.gov/docs/regstat031301.html>).
